Relative clauses / participles

Relative clauses

Relative clauses give us extra information about something/someone or identify which particular thing/person we are talking about. They are often introduced by the following words.

Use	Example
which (for things and animals)	*Did you see the film* ***which*** *was on TV last night?*
who (for people, and animals when we want to give them a personality)	*Tom Davies,* ***who*** *is appearing in concert in Reading this week, is with me in the studio.*
when (for times)	*Do you remember the day* ***when*** *we met?*
where (for places)	*This is the place* ***where*** *they filmed* Citizen Kane.
why (for reasons)	*That's the reason* ***why*** *he's so popular.*
whom (for people as the object of the relative clause)	*Is that the man* ***whom*** *we saw at the cinema yesterday?*
whose (for possession)	*My next guest on the show is John Travolta,* ***whose*** *career goes back to the early seventies.*

Watch out!

- When the relative pronoun (*who, which,* etc) is the subject of the relative clause, you do **not** need another subject.
  - ✓ *I admire Jude Law,* ***who*** *always works hard on his films.*
  - ✗ ~~*I admire Jude Law,* ***who he*** *always works hard on his films.*~~
- *Whom* is quite formal. It is natural in informal English to use *who* instead of *whom*, even when it is the object of the relative clause. After a preposition, however, we always use *whom*. Informally, we usually put the preposition at the end of the clause and use *who*.
  - ✓ *Is that the man* ***who*** *we saw at the cinema yesterday?*
  - ✓ *Charlie Chaplin was a comic genius* ***to whom*** *all comedians owe a great deal.*
  - ✓ *Charlie Chaplin was a comic genius* ***who*** *all comedians owe a great deal* ***to****.*
- *Where* can be replaced by a preposition + *which*. Less formally, we can put the preposition at the end of the clause.
  - ✓ *The theatre* ***where / in which*** *I first acted is somewhere around here.*
  - ✓ *The theatre* ***which*** *I first acted* ***in*** *is somewhere around here.*
- We can do the same thing with *when*.
  - ✓ *Do you know the year* ***when / in which*** *the first western was made?*
  - ✓ *Do you know the year* ***which*** *the first western was made* ***in****?*

Non-defining relative clauses

Non-defining relative clauses simply give us more information about something/someone. The sentence makes complete sense without the relative clause.

Use	Example
To give extra information about something/someone	*Ray Watson,* ***who starred in*** **Bandits**, *is considering making a film based on the life of Einstein.*

Watch out!

- Non-defining relative clauses are separated from the rest of the sentence by commas.
  - ✓ Megamonsters, *which was filmed in New York, is a very disappointing film.*
- We cannot leave out the word which introduces the relative clause and we cannot use the word *that* instead.
  - ✗ ~~Megamonsters, *was filmed in New York, is a very disappointing film.*~~
  - ✗ ~~Megamonsters, ***that*** *was filmed in New York, is a very disappointing film.*~~
- *Which* can refer back to the whole of the sentence.
  - ✓ *We finally got tickets for the concert,* ***which*** *was very lucky.*
    (It doesn't mean the concert was lucky. It means getting tickets for the concert was lucky.)

Defining relative clauses

Defining relative clauses tell us which one of a group of things/people we are talking about. The sentence doesn't usually make complete sense without the relative clause.

Use	Example
To tell us which one of a group of things/people we are talking about	*The book which I've read was the best of all.* *The one **who** is wearing a blue shirt is Justin Timberlake, isn't it?*

- Defining relative clauses are not separated from the rest of the sentence by commas.
  ✓ *This is the DVD which I told you about the other day.*
- We can also use *that* to introduce the relative clause.
  ✓ *This is the DVD **that** I told you about the other day.*
- We can often leave out the word which introduces the relative clause when it is the object of the clause.
  ✓ *This is the DVD I told you about the other day.*
- Notice that we do not need a preposition when we use *where* or *when*.
  ✓ *The theatre **where** I first acted is somewhere around here.*
  ✗ ~~*The theatre **where** I first acted **in** is somewhere around here.*~~
  ✓ *Do you know the year **when** the first western was made?*
  ✗ ~~*Do you know the year **when** the first western was made **in**?*~~

Participles

Present participles end in *-ing*.
Past participles usually end in *-ed*, although there are many irregular verbs.
Perfect participles are formed using *having* + past participle.

Use	Example
To follow prepositions and conjunctions (present and perfect participles)	*By **appearing** in that cigarette advert, he damaged his acting career.* *After **playing / having played** video games all morning, I was really tired.*
To explain the reason for something (present and perfect participles)	***Being** quite good looking, Ralph decided to make a career as a model.* ***Having seen** the film before, I knew what was going to happen.*
To talk about actions happening at the same time (present participles)	***Waiting** for the show to begin, I felt really nervous.*
To replace some relative clauses (present and past participles)	*Imagine being the person **directing** a big budget film! (= Imagine being the person **who is directing** a big budget film!)* *The person **chosen** for the part will be contacted by phone. (= The person **who is chosen** for the part will be contacted by phone.)*
To talk about past actions happening in sequence (perfect participles)	***Having finished** my homework, I decided to go to the cinema.*
As an alternative passive form (past participles)	***Made** to wait, the actor began to get very annoyed.*

- You have to be careful that the participle and the rest of the sentence both refer to the same subject.
  ✓ *Watching TV, I saw a news report about Hollywood.*
  ✗ *Watching TV, a news report came on about Hollywood.*

A Circle the correct word.

1 The minister, **which / who** was appointed just last week, made no comment on the situation.
2 Isn't that the spot **which / where** the accident happened last night?
3 The human brain, **which / who** weighs about 1400 grammes, is ten times the size of a baboon's.
4 There are several reasons **which / why** I don't want to see Michael tonight.
5 This is the office **which / where** I work.
6 The new girl in our class, **who's / whose** name is Alexandra, seems really nice.
7 The *Titanic*, **which / that** people said was unsinkable, sank on her maiden voyage.
8 All the people to **who / whom** the e-mail was sent replied.
9 April 1st, **which / when** we play tricks on people, is known as April Fools' Day.
10 Harry Hill, **who / whose** new series starts next week, is one of my favourite comedians.
11 A very popular breed of dog is the German Shepherd, **which / who** is often used as a guard dog.
12 Blackpool Tower, **which / that** was modelled on the Eiffel Tower, is a very well-known landmark.

B If a word in bold is correct, put a tick (✓). If it is incorrect, rewrite it correctly.

1 November 5th was the day **which** Guy Fawkes tried to blow up Parliament. .....
2 There were none of my favourite biscuits left when I had a cup of tea, **that** was really annoying. .....
3 I've just got a new webcam **that** takes really clear pictures. .....
4 *The Godfather* was made by Francis Ford Copolla, **who's** daughter is also a film director. .....
5 Can you think of any reason **which** Cathy should be angry with me? .....
6 Here's a photo of the hotel **where** we stayed in when we were in Beijing. .....
7 How do you think the first man **whom** walked on the moon felt? .....
8 This is the first occasion on **which** the leaders of these two countries have met. .....
9 He is a person for **who** very few people feel much sympathy. .....
10 The moment **which** the hero suddenly appears from behind a tree is the best moment in the whole film. .....
11 I met a man **which** had a dog with only three legs. .....
12 My new school, **who** I moved to about a month ago, seems like quite a friendly place. .....

C Rewrite as one sentence using a relative clause.

1 My friend, Simon, plays the guitar. He has just released a CD.
My friend, Simon, who has just released a CD, plays the guitar. .....
2 Prince Charles is heir to the throne of England. His wife was Princess Diana.
.....
3 Microsoft has a lot of power in the world of computers. That annoys some people.
.....
4 The euro replaced a number of national currencies. It was introduced in January 2002.
.....

5 *Friends* ran for ten years. It is one of my favourite series.

.....

6 Venus is a very hot place. It is much closer to the Sun than the Earth is.

.....

7 Cricket is popular in many countries around the world. It is played between two teams of eleven.

.....

8 Parts of Buckingham Palace are open to the public. It is where the queen lives.

.....

9 The greyhound is the fastest dog. It can reach speeds of over 65 kilometres an hour.

.....

10 *1984* was written by George Orwell. His real name was Eric Blair.

.....

D Write one word in each gap. Do not write *that* and do not leave any gaps blank.

Find me a show that works

by our TV reviewer, Jeremy Platt

I'm sure there was a reason (**1**) ..... I became a TV reviewer. Maybe it was my love of classic shows (**2**) ..... kept me entertained as a child. Or maybe it was the presenters (**3**) ..... seemed to promise an exciting world of glamour and showbiz. To be honest, I've watched so many shows lately (**4**) ..... have bored me to tears that I've forgotten. Take *Kid Swap*, for example, the new show (**5**) ..... Channel 7 hopes will revive their viewing figures. The show takes kids (**6**) ..... parents have had enough and swaps them with kids from other families for two weeks. The problem with this show is that I'm just not sure at (**7**) ..... it's aimed – parents or teenagers. Parents (**8**) ..... watch this show will find it childish, particularly at the moment (**9**) ..... one of the teenagers does nothing but complain. Teenage viewers (**10**) ..... watch more than the first five minutes will soon get bored of the parents, (**11**) ..... blame anybody but themselves for the situation. This is definitely one idea (**12**) ..... should be put exactly where it belongs – in the bin!

E Tick (✓) the gaps in Exercise D which could be completed using *that*. Put a cross (✗) where *that* could not be used.

1	**4**	**7**	**10** .....
2	**5**	**8**	**11** .....
3	**6**	**9**	**12** .....

F Choose the correct answer.

1 'Who's that over there?'
'Oh, it's our new teacher, ... just started work today.'
A that C which he
B who he D who

2 'Which CD did you get Marcus in the end?'
'I got him the one ..... said he really wanted to hear.'
A that C which
B who he D which he

3 'Who did you send a Valentine's card to?'
'I'm not telling you, but it was someone ..... name begins with "B".'
A which C whose
B who her D whose her

4 'Have you seen Jason Green's latest film?'
'Is that the one in ..... joins the FBI?'
A which he C whom he
B that he D which

5 'Why do you like Tania so much?'
'Well, she's one of the few people to ..... I can really talk.'
A which C that
B whom D who

6 'Why don't we go to Lionel's for dinner tonight?'
'Is that the new restaurant ..... has just opened on the other side of town?'
A which C where
B that it D which it

7 'Could you lend me some money?'
'I'd like you to give me one good reason ..... I should.'
A that C which
B why D who

8 'What do you want to do this summer?'
'I think we should go somewhere ..... has plenty of sun and sand.'
A who C when
B where D that

G Circle the words in bold which are *not* necessary.

The number of options (1) **that** are available to us with (2) **which** to fill our leisure time is increasing all the time. While previous generations, (3) **who** lived before the electronic age, had musical instruments and card games (4) **that** they played to pass the time, we have PlayStations, computers, televisions and stereos. Although parents (5) **whose** teenagers spend a lot of time on these activities might worry about the effect (6) **which** it is having on them, for most of us they provide harmless fun, (7) **which** is becoming more important as life becomes more stressful. The television programmes (8) **which** we watch and the computer games (9) **that** we play all entertain us and, although there will always be people to (10) **whom** they seem a complete waste of time, the effect (11) **that** they have on society cannot be ignored. Entertainment is something (12) **which** we all need and, as long as we're willing to pay, there will always be someone (13) **who** is willing to provide it.

H Circle the correct word or phrase.

1 Before **meeting / met** Harriet, I never knew what real love was.
2 I'm sure that after **passing / passed** your exam, you'll feel a lot better.
3 Having **finishing / finished** the letter, Peter printed it out.
4 **Looking / Looked** through the window, I saw a strange man at the door.
5 I cooked dinner and, **doing / having done** that, I sat down to watch TV.
6 **Hearing / Heard** a noise outside, Janice went to investigate.
7 **Having lost / Losing** my notes, I couldn't revise properly for the test.
8 **Having been / Being** quite intelligent, Matt hopes to get into a good university.
9 **Having missed / Missing** the start of the film, I decided not to bother watching the rest of it.
10 After **making / made** her bed, Cherie had a shower.

I Complete the sentences so that the meaning remains the same.

1 I suddenly remembered where I'd left my keys when I was waiting for the bus.
Waiting .....

2 I slipped because I was trying to run in the rain.
Trying .....

3 I felt quite sorry for Tim when I saw him cry.
Seeing .....

4 John was depressed because he knew he was going to fail the exam.
Knowing .....

5 The reason I'm quite good at basketball is that I'm quite tall.
Being .....

6 Georgia didn't know any Japanese so she used a phrase book when she was there.
Not .....

7 Ed can afford three holidays abroad each year because he has a lot of money.
Having .....

8 Maria began to worry when she realised she was lost.
Realising .....

J Tick (✓) the correct sentences. If a sentence is incorrect, rewrite it correctly.

1 Looking through the window, a plane was passing overhead.
.....

2 Realising that it was late, I ran all the way home.
.....

3 Having examined me, I was given a prescription by the doctor.
.....

4 Turning on the television, the newsreader said there had been an explosion.
.....

5 Dropping the shopping bags on the kitchen floor, Mrs Moorcroft sighed and sat down heavily.
.....

6 Having practised the piano, I decided to call one of my friends.
.....

K If a line is correct, put a tick (✓) next to the number. If there is an extra word in a line, write it next to the number.

1 ..... 'Hello, viewers, and welcome to *Easy Money*, the game show who you
2 ..... voted the best on TV! Now, remember yesterday when our current champion,
3 ..... Pat Barber, having been won ten thousand euros, decided to carry on? Well,
4 ..... she's here tonight and she's going for the star prize, which it is a brand new
5 ..... sports car! That's right. Having got her this far, if Pat can answer three more
6 ..... questions correctly, then she could be driving home in this car, ladies and
7 ..... gentlemen. Having not seen the programme before, you will know just how
8 ..... difficult which it can be. I know Pat's a little nervous, but I'm sure she'll be
9 ..... fine and there's one person for whom tonight is very special and that's Pat's
10 ..... husband, Frank, who he is sitting in the audience. So, let's play *Easy Money*!